

Clowder: Co-op

Objective: As a team of sleuths, work together to earn as many experience points as possible by recovering clowders. The team fails if all magnifying glass tokens are flipped, or if any sleuth has no clowder by the end of the game.

Setup: Deal cards face down — 5 per player (2p) or 4 per player (3-4p) — from the shuffled 52-card deck. Place the rest in the middle as the Lost Kitties draw deck. Each player takes 4 paw tokens (2p) or 3 (3-4p), face up. Set 3 magnifying glass tokens face up by the deck.

IMPORTANT: Pick up your cards without seeing the fronts. Hold them facing outward — you see everyone's cards but your own.



Paw Tokens: Spent to give clues or ask for cards. Disable (flip face down) when used.

Magnifying Glass Tokens: These are your team's sleuth status. You start with 3, face up. If all 3 are flipped, the game ends and the team loses.

Mouse Cards: They act as wild cards and can help complete a clowder of any kind.

Mistake: When a mistake occurs, flip a magnifying glass token face down and shuffle all cards involved in the mistake back into the Lost Kitties draw deck, even ones that could have been played.



On your turn (Choose one):

Hint (disable 1 paw token): Tell another player the season or name of some of their cards, plus the quantity, pointing to each. Clues must be complete — point to every matching card.

Example: "You have 3 Sled Cats" or "You have 3 Winter Kitties," pointing to all 3.



Mouse clue: Cat and season clues never include mice. Clue mice separately: "You have 2 mice," pointing to each.

Place: Lay down card(s) in front of you to start a new clowder, add to one in progress, or complete one. Draw back to starting hand size. You cannot start a new Clowder with a Mouse card.

****Mistake:** Cards don't form a valid clowder, or a Mouse card starts a new clowder. (See Mistake)

Ask (disable 1 paw token): Ask another player for a specific card and quantity (by name or season). Example: "I want your 3 Sled kittens." Give no hints and don't touch their cards. They hand over the matching cards, which you place immediately. The asked player then draws back to their starting hand size.

Mouse Ask: You may ask for mice by name. Example: "I want your 2 mice." You may not ask for a mouse as a cat or a season.

****Mistake:** You receive the wrong cards. (see Mistake)

Transfer: Give another player card(s) to add to or complete a clowder in progress. You cannot transfer cards to start a new clowder. Draw back to starting hand size.

****Mistake:** The cards can't be played immediately. (see Mistake)

Release (enable 1 Paw token): Discard 1 card, put face up. Draw back to starting hand size.

Complete Clowders: See Clowder Basics for experience points and paw token recovery.

Borrow Status (Disable Magnifying Glass): When you're out of paw tokens you may spend a magnifying glass token in place of one.

Recover Status: Complete a Colony to enable a magnifying glass token. You can't go above your starting 3. (see Clowder Basics, Colonies)

End of Game (Co-op): When the Lost Kitties deck runs out, each player takes one final turn. The team loses one magnifying glass token for each unfinished clowder. The team wins if every player has at least one completed clowder and at least one magnifying glass token remains. The team loses if all magnifying glass tokens are flipped, or if any player has no completed clowder. Each enabled (face-up) magnifying glass token is worth 1 point.

See how you did (points):

1-10: Rookies (more XP needed!)

11-20: Goodie Gumshoes!

21-30: Famous Shamuses!

31-40: Private Eyes: Catchin' Cats!

41-50: True "Crazy Cat Lady" Detectives!

51+: Legends, impossible!

Strategy: Communication is key. Although in-game actions are limited to Hints and Asks (which cost Paw Tokens), players are encouraged to strategize together, as long as they don't reveal hidden information. Keep track of how you spend your Paw Tokens, and think about the best ways to recover them. If you want to add or improve the rules, go for it! Most of all, have fun!

I would like to give special thanks to my wife for the beautiful artwork, to everyone who playtested and to the designers of games that inspired Clowder, including Hanabi by Antoine Bauza, and Go Fish. —Efrain

CLOWDER

A Deduction Game of Cats, Mice,
and Seasons
by Efrain Chu-Jon



Art by Ariel Chu-Jon

Clowder: A group of cats.

In the game Clowder, you're a neighborhood sleuth tracking down lost kitties that have been up to mischief all year. These furballs are picky, and they will only settle into a clowder with the right company. Follow the paw prints, round up the right kitties, and become the most seasoned detective on the block! Clowder can be played two ways: Versus or Co-op.

2-4 players, Ages 7+,
Time: 20-30 minutes

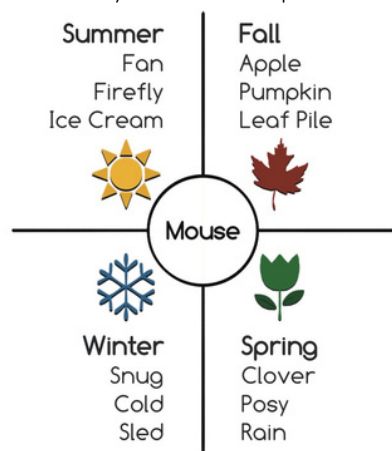
Components:

- 48 Kitty Cards
- 4 Mouse Cards
- 12 Paw Tokens
- 3 Magnifying glass tokens



Clowder Basics

In Clowder you have 3 cats per season:



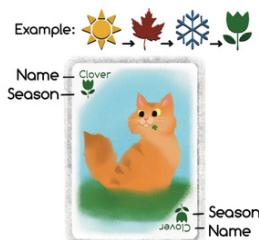
Clowder Types

Purrfect Clowder:
Group of 4 identical cats.

Seasonal Clowder:
VS: Group of 4 cats within the same season.

Co-op: Group of 3 distinct cats within the same season.

Yearly Clowder:
Group of 4 cats from different seasons placed in sequential order.



Experience Points:

Purrfect: 4 points

Seasonal: 3 points

Yearly: 2 points

In Versus: Any clowder containing mice scores 1 less (regardless of how many).

Paw Token Recovery:

Type	VS	Co-op
Purrfect	3	1
Seasonal	2	1
Yearly	1	2p: each player enables 2 3-4p: completer enables 2, others enable 1.

Colonies: A group of multiple clowders. Completing one or more grants bonus points and a special effect (see your mode).

Colony Name	Clowders Needed	Bonus Points
Purr-ennial	4 Purrfects, 1 per season	+5
Well-Seasoned	4 Seasonals, 1 per season	+4
Grand	1 of each type	+6

Game Modes:

Clowder: Versus (Go Kitty)

Objective: Form clowders to earn experience points. The sleuth with the most points at the end of the game wins!

Setup: Each player takes 3 paw tokens. Remove the Mouse cards and shuffle the 48 Kitty cards. Deal face down: 7 per player (2p) or 5 per player (3-4p). Shuffle the Mouse cards back into the remaining deck, place it in the middle as the Lost Kitties draw deck, and set the 3 magnifying glass tokens beside it.

Hideaways: Before the first turn, players may create up to 2 hideaways by placing cards face down (1-3 cards each). These cards are "safe" from the Ask Action.



Minimum hand size: You must keep at least 4 cards in hand (2p) or 3 cards in hand (3-4p).

Paw Tokens: Spent on special actions (Insist, Scout, Snoop). Disable (flip face down) when used.

Magnifying Glass Tokens: When you complete a clowder, you may take one magnifying glass token instead of recovering paw tokens. Spend it on Investigate or Protect (return to center after), or keep it unused for 1 experience point at game's end.

Mouse Cards: They act as wild cards and can help complete a clowder of any kind.

Nope: Discard a Mouse card to "nope" an Ask action made against you — the asker gets nothing, and you may immediately take an Ask action against that player. That counter-Ask can be noped the same way, chaining until someone doesn't. Each nope discards one Mouse card. You can't nope paw-token actions.

Turn Order: The person who most recently saw a cat in real life (or left of the dealer) goes first.

On your turn:

1. Gather (optional): Before an action, you may gather all your cards (hand and hideaways) into your hand.
2. Take one action.
3. Complete clowders (optional): After your action, you may complete one or more clowders.
4. Replenish: Draw back up to minimum hand size. (This ends clowder-building for the turn).
5. Make hideaways (optional): You may create hideaways to end your turn, as long as you keep at least your minimum hand size.
6. Double tap to signify your turn is over.

Actions:

Ask: Cards come only from the target's hand, never their hideaways. You may not ask for Mouse cards. Choose one of the following two:

By Season: "Do you have any [season] cats?" The target gives you 1 card of that Season.

By Kitty Name (Show Proof): Reveal one [kitty name] from your hand, then say "Give me all your [kitty name] cards." The target gives you all cards of that name.
**If they have none, they say "Go Kitty" and you draw 1 card from Lost Kitties.

Insist (disable a paw token): Ask another player for any season or kitty name (no proof), or one Mouse card. The target gives you all matching cards.
**If they have none, they say "Go Kitty" and you draw 1 card from Lost Kitties

Scout (disable a paw token): Look at the top 3 of Lost Kitties deck. Keep 1; put the other 2 on the bottom.

Snoop (disable a paw token): Choose one of another player's hideaways and take 2 cards from it (or 1, if that's all it holds). Look privately, keep 1, and return the rest face down.

Investigate (use magnifying glass): Look at up to 4 cards across another player's hideaways. Take 1; return the rest face down.

Protect (use magnifying glass): After taking your action, place the token on top of one of your hideaways. No one may look at it until your next turn, when you return the token to the center.

**If an action drops a target below their minimum hand size, they immediately draw from Lost Kitties back up to the minimum.

End of Game: The end game is triggered when the Lost Kitties deck runs out or when a player completes one or more Colonies. Each player takes one final turn and then the game ends. Score points from Clowders, Colonies, and each unused magnifying glass token you're holding (1 point each).